IBM Concert Platform – FAQ (Internal Use Only)

Last Review: August 10th 2026

Questions? ibm-concert-platform-ama (slack)

This is a living document – and will be updated over time. If there is something missing/inaccurate/out of date, please let me know.

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1. Strategy & Positioning

What is the simplest way to describe IBM Concert platform?

IBM Concert platform is a unified IT operations platform that connects signals, context, and teams across an enterprise's existing technology stack.

It acts as the single pane of glass and coordination layer across applications, infrastructure, networks, and operations workflows—helping organizations cut through alert noise, understand what matters most, and respond more effectively.

IBM Concert platform works with, not instead of, a customer's current tools. It ingests signals from across the environment, unifies them into shared context, and uses AI-powered agents to surface priorities, recommend actions, and support coordinated response across teams. The result is faster issue resolution, improved resilience, and simpler operations—without a rip-and-replace approach.

Why does the platform matter now?

As organizations scale hybrid environments, multicloud architectures, and AI-powered applications, operational complexity is growing faster than teams can manage with siloed tools and manual coordination. Signal volumes are exploding, dependencies are increasing, and traditional point solutions leave teams reacting to symptoms instead of understanding root causes.

IBM Concert platform matters now because it shifts operations from fragmented, tool-centric workflows to coordinated, context-driven decision-making. By creating shared context across applications, infrastructure, networks, and teams, Concert platform helps organizations cut through noise, align priorities, and respond with speed and confidence.

In an environment where downtime, cost overruns, and resilience gaps have immediate business impact, IBM Concert platform provides the foundation enterprises need to operate at scale—without slowing innovation or requiring a rip-and-replace of existing investments.

How should I explain the capability model inside IBM Concert platform? Is this a rip-and-replace single monolith play?

IBM Concert platform is organized around modular operational capabilities that map to customer jobs-to-be-done, while sharing a common platform foundation underneath. These capabilities currently include Observe, Optimize, Protect, Resilience, and Operate, each powered by the IBM products customers know today. For example, Observe is powered by Instana and SevOne, Optimize by Turbonomic, Protect by Concert, Resilience by Concert and NS1, and Operate by AIOps and Concert.

These capabilities are connected by shared platform services that provide the common foundation for the platform experience. Those services include identity and access management / SSO, the Concert platform data access layer, AI foundations/framework services, shared policies, and common workflow and user experience elements. This shared foundation is what enables unified navigation, consistent onboarding, cross-capability insights, and coordinated workflows across the platform.

Customers can purchase the entire platform – or asf a flexible, modular solution. For example, a client can just start with IBM Concert Observe or IBM Concert Protect – buying/paying for just 1 solution within the platform.

What are the shared platform services?

The platform includes shared services such as single sign-on / identity and access management, the Concert platform data access layer, AI foundations/framework services, and common policy management. These services provide the connective tissue that enables unified workflows, shared context, and cross-capability insights.

What operational problems are IBM Concert platform designed to solve?

IBM Concert platform is designed for environments where operational complexity has outpaced the current tooling model. In many organizations, data is fragmented across application, infrastructure, network, and cost tools; teams are forced to manually stitch together context; and decisions are made locally while operational outcomes are global. IBM Concert platform addresses this by creating shared context, reducing manual correlation, and coordinating response across domains and teams.

Is this a product rebrand or a real change in product experience?

It's a true technical investment in a unified platform experience. IBM Concert brings together our Observability and Networking products into a cohesive platform with built-in AI, consistent UX, shared identity and data, and cross-product workflows—enabling outcomes not possible with siloed tools.

Do Instana, Turbonomic, SevOne, NS1, and Concert still remain as seperate products?

Yes. Each capability remains an individual product, continuing to be sold and ordered independently. What's new is that they can now also be consumed through the Concert platform.

Customers will be able to purchase a single Concert platform part that includes the participating capabilities, such as Concert Observe, Concert Optimize, and other supported capabilities. Customers do not separately order each capability as an individual product within Concert.

After purchase, customers can choose which capabilities to deploy and use. They only incur consumption or entitlement usage for the capabilities they use. For example, if a customer only wants to use the Turbonomic capability through Concert Optimize, they can purchase enough committed spend, subscription entitlement, or resource units to cover that expected usage, then deploy and use only Concert Optimize.

Will SevOne and NS1 move into the Automation organization?

No. There are no plans for changes to organizational structures. Network product teams will continue collaborating within the Concert platform while maintaining existing reporting lines. With that said, we do plan to market, integrate, and make SevOne and NS1 capabilities available within the Concert platform.

Will Cloud Pak for AIOps (CP4AIOps) be included?

Yes, Cloud Pak for AIOps form the core, foundational technology behind Concert Operate solution across both On-Prem and SaaS deployments of Concert Platform. Following GA, AIOps capabilities will be seamlessly onboarded into the Concert Platform, delivering powerful, unified event and incident correlation, advanced topology mapping, intelligent diagnostics, and guided as well as automated remediation. Together, these capabilities

will enrich and enable the Concert Operate solution to serve as the central engine for modern, intelligent Event Operations and Management."

How is this different from Solis?

Solis is a broader initiative aimed at connecting the Concert platform with the wider IBM portfolio (such as IWHI, Maximo, and MaaS360). In contrast, the Concert platform is focused on entering the ITOM market with a unified experience—bringing integrated capabilities together under a single, purchasable offering.

Components between the Solis platform and Concert platform will be shared, with contributions flowing in both directions. The Concert platform intends to leverage and build on existing Solus components, while new components, such as a shared entity correlation service, will either be adapted by Solis or co-created jointly between the teams. This approach ensures other product groups can benefit equally from these shared capabilities, eliminating the need for each team to recreate similar components on their own.

What problem does the platform solve that individual products did not?

Individual products solved specific problems well, but customers increasingly struggle with operating them together. As IT environments grow more complex, customers prefer fewer, more comprehensive ITOM platforms rather than managing multiple disconnected tools.

While IBM’s individual products deliver strong standalone capabilities, customers often had to manually stitch together identities, insights, and workflows across products. The Concert platform addresses this gap by unifying identity, experience, and execution into a single platform—reducing operational overhead, accelerating time to value, and making it easier for customers to start small and scale through integrated capabilities.

How should we explain this to existing customers?

The initial announcement and GA are focused on new customer environments. Existing Instana and Turbonomic customers are not required to migrate, and their current production deployments will continue to operate as they do today.

For existing customers who want to explore the Concert platform, the recommended path is to stand up a new Concert environment alongside their existing deployment. This allows them to evaluate Concert capabilities without disrupting their current operations.

At this stage, customers should not assume that an existing standalone Instana or Turbonomic deployment can be automatically upgraded or migrated into Concert. Moving an existing production environment into the Concert platform may require a formal migration process, redeployment, reconfiguration, and/or import of settings and data, depending on the customer's current environment and the supported migration options available at that time.

Migration of existing production environments is not expected until 2027, giving customers ample time to evaluate the platform, understand the available migration paths, and plan accordingly.

The key message for existing customers is: we are adding value without disrupting what they already rely on. Their core product capabilities remain unchanged. Concert introduces an additional platform layer designed to bring products together through deeper integrations, shared data, unified workflows, AI-driven insights, and consistent policy management over time.

What can I say to clients today?

IBM Concert® is an agentic IT Ops platform that creates an adaptable, unified operational layer across your environment. It connects signals, generates shared context, and coordinates action across teams and tools, so your entire system operates as one. With cross-domain intelligence, Concert helps you reduce risk, maintain business continuity, improve performance, and optimize cost across the stack.

Powered by agentic AI, it surfaces what matters, prioritizes by business impact, and orchestrates action through governed workflows.

Read more on the blog and watch our webinar. Share with clients our 101 deck and client leave behind.

What does "open" / no rip-and-replace mean in practice?

"Open" means IBM Concert platform is designed to work with the customer's existing environment rather than requiring them to replace it first. The platform is being positioned for hybrid, multicloud, and multi-vendor reality, and the intended value

proposition is to make the existing stack smarter and more coordinated—not to require customers to standardize on a single tool before they can get value.

In practice, this means customers can start with the IBM capabilities they need most while benefiting from shared platform services such as unified experience, identity, workflows, AI foundations, and data correlation. Over time, the roadmap also calls for broader third-party support in areas such as the data layer, agentic AI workflows, and event management. This third-party support is expected to arrive in limited forms with the introduction of Concert Operate in Q3 2026.

What do the launch use cases actually do?

The launch use cases are intended to demonstrate the value of coordinated operations across domains, not just individual point-product features.

See more about our platform use cases on Seismic here.

How can an existing customer try the platform safely?

The initial announcement and GA are focused on new customer environments. Existing customers are not required to migrate and will not see changes to their current production environments. Customers who want to explore the platform can do so by standing up a new Concert environment alongside their existing deployments. Migration of existing production environments will not occur until 2027, providing ample time for evaluation and planning.

For preview and evaluation, current enablement material references multiple pre-GA and launch experiences, including a public demo, private sandbox, and private bring-your-own non-production data preview. This gives existing customers a lower-risk way to assess the experience and use cases before broader production migration options are introduced.

2. Naming & Identity

What is the official platform name?

Legal name: IBM Concert *(the 2024 product IBM Concert and the platform are now one of the same, IBM Concert (2024 launch product) features are now referred to by the following conventions).*

First mention: “IBM Concert platform” (Note that the term “platform” must always be lower case)

Subsequent mentions: “IBM Concert,” or “Concert”

Examples:

Do

“Manage operations across your environment with the IBM Concert platform” (first mention)

“Within Concert, you can enable additional capabilities.” (second mention)

Don’t

×Don’t use “Concert” as the first external reference

×Don’t use “IBM Concert Platform” as a capitalized proper noun (use “IBM Concert platform” if you need to use the word platform)

What is “ITOM” or ITOM platform?

ITOM – IT Operations Management – This is the market.

IBM Concert platform – Is IBM’s play in the ITOM market.

IBM ITOM platform is another term used interchangeably with IBM Concert platform.

How should we refer to products in collateral today?

When referring to our products OUTSIDE of a platform instance.

Existing product naming	May 5, first mention
Instana	Instana, now part of the Concert platform
SevOne on-prem	SevOne, now part of the Concert platform
SevOne SaaS *(not yet available)*	Concert Network Observability, powered by SevOne
Turbonomic	Turbonomic, now part of the Concert platform

Concert	Concert Resilience
Concert	Concert Workflows
Concert	Concert Protect

When using our existing products, WITHIN a platform instance.

Existing product naming	May 5, first mention
Instana	Concert Core Observability, powered by Instana
Instana features	Concert Application Observability, powered by Instana Concert Infrastructure Observability, powered by Instana Concert AI/LLM Observability, powered by Instana Concert Digital Experience Monitoring, powered by Instana
SevOne	Concert Network Observability, powered by SevOne
Turbonomic	Concert Optimize, powered by Turbonomic
Cloud Pak for AIOps *(some capabilities)*	Concert Operate
Concert	Concert Resilience
Concert	Concert Workflows
Concert	Concert Protect

If you have further questions or need further clarification about the naming conventions, please reach out to us on Slack!

3. Commercials & Packaging

How will the platform be packaged and priced?

We currently have our Software / On-Prem pricing and packaging available here on Seismic.

SaaS pricing will be available upon SaaS GA in August.

Can customers still buy products individually?

Yes. The platform introduces an additional consumption model and is not a replacement for standalone product purchasing which are still available for purchase.

How can customers buy it? Where do they go?

Concert will be sold through IBM direct sales and authorized partners. For the initial launch, the offering is primarily intended for new customers and new environments, while IBM finalizes the commercial trade-up / upgrade process and the technical migration path for existing Instana, Turbonomic, SevOne, or NS1 customers.

Customers should work with their IBM seller or IBM Business Partner to determine the right packaging option, including SaaS Committed Spend, SaaS Subscription, or On-Prem / client-hosted options where applicable.

The Concert platform offering is also expected to be listed on AWS Marketplace and the IBM Cloud Catalog.

Existing customers interested in Concert should engage their IBM seller to discuss evaluation options. In the near term, this will typically mean deploying a new Concert environment rather than assuming an immediate trade-up, in-place upgrade, or direct migration of an existing production deployment.

Will there be multiple part numbers for this multiple offers?

One part for Concert platform that gives the customer access to all products in the platform (currently for June GA: Concert, Instana, Turbo, and SevOne).

Is it going to be a unified capabilities offering with one part #?

Customers can purchase the entire platform – or as a flexible, modular solution. For example, a client can just start with IBM Concert Observe or IBM Concert Protect – buying/paying for just 1 solution within the platform.

New clients: 1 single PID for Concert platform, with SaaS subscription and On-Prem software.

Existing clients: if they want to move from a single product (today) into the platform (GA), we will have trade-up parts available, however technical migration is not available at this time.

What is going to be the grace period for Partners on proficiencies for the stand-alone products?

As long as they have any stand-alone proficiencies of the product part of the grouping, they can sell the whole platform. We are not looking to do a proficiency for the platform.

Trade ups? Will they make customers trade up or not

Trade-up is not the right term, does not apply to subscription-to-SCS upgrade (trade-up is a term related to on-prem offerings). For GA we are supporting new customers, with customers having to expire their current contract and then renew to the Concert platform SCS offering. We are also looking into introducing trade-up and upgrade parts to help with the transition from other current contracting options to Concert platform, but this may not be available at GA.

Will this be a UT30 created specifically for Concert platform? If so, will it only have Concert platform part numbers within it?

Concert product UT30 is being re-purposed for new contract options for Concert platform (i.e., SaaS Subscription and On-Prem (self-hosted)).

4. Roadmap

When will IBM Concert platform be available to the general public?

IBM Concert platform is generally available for software / on-prem now. It will be available for SaaS in August 2026.

Roadmap is available on Seismic here.

How often do/will you release updates or new versions?

We will start with monthly releases but will adjust as needed.

Are we developing for On-Prem, SaaS or both?

Both. IBM Concert platform is being developed with both SaaS and On-Prem in mind

Will IBM Concert platform work on Z or Power?

The Concert platform and its solutions possess capabilities that support power and Z today (e.g: Instana on Z/OS), none of that capability is changing or going away with the unification into Concert platform.

We are actively exploring ways to surface these insights at the platform level and are exploring use cases for Z and Power customers. If you are interested in helping us develop these, please reach out to the Product Team on slack.

5. AI Capabilities

Where can I understand more about the AI being used in the Concert platform?

Our AI team has extensive documentation located here.

What kind of AI Models are being used in the platform?

Granite, Mistral, OpenAI, Slate. Full overview here.

What are the AI use cases in the Concert Platform?

The platform “inherits” many of the AI use cases present in Instana, Turbonomic & Concert (2024-launched product) today. Thanks to the platform and its capabilities, it also opens the door for many new cross-product use cases. See more.

6. Installation, Onboarding & Homepage

How do I install IBM Concert platform?

We host detailed developer documentation here.

What is this homepage meant to do?

The homepage is meant to give each user a clear, immediate understanding of what matters most in their environment. Instead of requiring users to piece together information across multiple systems, it surfaces the most relevant insights, issues, and actions up front.

Is this just a dashboard?

No. The concept goes beyond a static dashboard. It is designed as a dynamic, intent-based operational surface that adapts to the user's role, priorities, and current context.

What makes it different from other operational homepages?

Its key difference is personalization. Rather than showing the same layout and metrics to everyone, it tailors the experience based on the user's responsibilities, goals, and preferred signals.

How does the personalization work?

Personalization starts with a conversational onboarding flow. Users provide information such as their role, focus area, and the metrics they care about, and the experience is configured around that input.

What does the onboarding experience do?

The onboarding experience helps users quickly define what matters to them so the homepage can be tailored appropriately. It is designed to be lightweight, fast, and easy to complete.

Who is this experience for?

The experience is designed for multiple personas, including executive leaders, engineering leaders, and site reliability engineers. Each persona sees a different view of the same underlying operational environment, shaped around their needs.

What kind of information does the homepage show for an SRE?

It shows a mix of operational summaries, key risks, performance indicators, alerts, trends, and recommended focus areas. The goal is to help users quickly understand current status and where attention is needed.

What is the new value for executives?

At a high level, the experience is designed to serve both operational and engineering executives.

For operational executives, the experience is organized around three core themes: health, performance, and risk. These themes distill complex environments into clear, actionable summary signals that support day-to-day and strategic operational decision-making.

For engineering-focused executives, the experience centers on a single core theme: resilience. This view brings together health metrics alongside resilience investments and cost savings, highlighting where those investments improve outcomes across the phases of the software development lifecycle.

To support these differing perspectives, we offer several out-of-the-box homepage designs aligned to each theme, allowing executives to quickly adopt an experience that best matches their specific area of focus.

Why are health, performance, and risk so important?

These three signals provide a simple way to understand the state of an environment without overwhelming users with raw metrics. They help users quickly assess whether operations are stable, where problems may be forming, and what may need intervention.

Can users interact with what they see?

Yes. The experience is designed to be interactive, allowing users to hover, click, and drill into additional detail when they want more context behind a score, insight, or recommendation.

What is the overall value of this experience?

The overall value is helping users move faster from signal to understanding to action. It reduces noise, improves visibility across tools, and gives each user a more relevant and actionable view of their environment.

7. Concert platform

Read more about our architecture on Seismic.

Useful information about how the various architectural pieces fit together can be found in the installation guide.

What is it?

The Concert Platform Data Access Layer provides a real-time, federated, GraphQL-based foundation that unifies data across products, tools, and domains. It creates a shared model of the platform so entities and signals can be consistently discovered, correlated, and traversed — by humans and machines. This removes fragmentation, duplication, and manual stitching.

Key Terminology:

- Concert platform data layer - The overall collection of data related services and storage that comprise multiple key components. The two key sub-layers of the data layer are:
  - Concert platform data collection (or data ingestion) layer - Initially a logical (physically separate) collection of the data collected from 3rd party data sources and processed and stored in one or more Concert platform solutions / capabilities. Over time, this will likely emerge into a single consolidated storage/data lake of data collected and maintained in the Concert platform that is required across one or more Platform solutions or capabilities.

    This is a separate but closely related workstream in the Concert platform.
  - Concert platform data access layer (Concert platform DAL)
    - Concert platform common data services - Key services that connect the metadata and data across products and provide a unified connective tissue using which correlated data can flow to consuming applications or UI. There are 2 key services that are part of this layer:
      - Entity correlation service
      - Entity relationship traversal service

      Underlying these services is a Common Data Model that comprises entities that are common across different capabilities in the platform and a map of

correlated unique identifiers that can be used to retrieve additional, consistent data from the source capability.

- Concert platform data access service - A GraphQL proxy engine that aggregates, manages and provides access to GraphQL endpoints across the Common data services and the individual products' data via a federated, unified GraphQL schema. Donwstream, consuming applications can query this layer to retrieve correlation and traversal information as well as correlated data across Concert platform solutions or capabilities.

What is the Data Access Layer?

The Concert platform DAL provides real-time, federated access to correlated data through its key services that include entity matching, relationship traversal, and data access.

How does the Concert platform DAL work?

The Concert platform DAL (Data Access Layer), works by creating and maintaining a map or graph of like entity types and entities (such as Application, Service, Image, Container, etc.) across the different capabilities in the platform (such as Application Observability, Optimization, Risk, Resilience etc.) and how the entity types are related so unique IDs to find them in the respective source can be retrieved and used for consistent, cross-capability data access. A standards-based (GraphQL) access is provided to this map or graph along with access to broader schema including capability metrics and data.

Consuming clients or UI can access the GraphQL access layer and execute either parameterized, pre-defined GraphQL queries or generate dynamic queries to answer a wide variety of questions on observability, optimization, risk and resilience.

What products or capabilities are data sources for the concert platform DAL?

For the June 2026 MVP GA release, Instana, Turbonomic and Concert will be the primary data sources for the Concert platform DAL.

What are examples of consuming clients of the Concert platform DAL?

An example of a consuming client of the Concert platform DAL are the Persona-based Homepages in the Concert platform UI. Data from the DAL powers both single capability insights as well as cross-product insights on these Homepages.

Another example is an AI Chat client.

What data entity types and entities are supported by the DAL?

The DAL supports a set of entities and metrics associated (the M part of MELT) with each capability on the Concert platform.

For June 2026 GA, the following diagram captures the key entities represented in the common model and the unified model. [NOTE: This may change slightly between now and GA timeframe]

How frequently is the common data model / graph updated?

The common data model / graph is refreshed every 10 minutes.

Does the Concert platform DAL store a timeline view of the common data model / graph?

Not in the June 2026 MVP GA release. Timeline view is in the roadmap and will be prioritized for a future release.

What the Concert platform DAL is not?

- It is not the answer to every problem we may have in the Concert platform (even though it's a very important part of it :))
- It does not cover ALL types of data - particularly it does not cover Events, Logs and Traces (the ELT part of MELT).
- It is not a physical data lake/data warehouse but a logical one (if you want to view it as that); the common data model is a limited physical store with only key identifiers stored for traversal and entity correlation.
- It will NOT by default expose ALL data from ALL products for general exploration and use; it will sufficiently cover most of the use cases slated for GA.

Can customers or partners access the Concert platform DAL?

In the MVP GA release in June 2026, access to the Concert platform DAL is restricted internal use – i.e, to the Concert platform UI and AI layers and to the capabilities only. It may be possible to support public APIs for partners or customers to access the DAL directly sometime in the future based on demand.

8. Targeting

What types of customers are the best fit for IBM Concert platform?

IBM Concert platform as a whole (i.e the platform play) is best suited for medium to large enterprises where operational complexity has outgrown the effectiveness of existing tools and processes. These organizations typically run hybrid or multicloud environments, rely on disconnected tools across multiple operational domains, and are seeking to improve resilience, reduce MTTR, control costs, and simplify operations—all without having to replace their current technology stack.

IBM Concert platform also works well for customers who initially engage with the platform through a specific, high-value capability such as Observe or Optimize rather than adopting the full platform from day one. As their needs evolve, Concert provides a natural expansion path, allowing customers to incrementally adopt additional capabilities and support more advanced use cases over time, along with a pricing model that enables them to size for only what they require.

Who are the primary buyer and user personas?

Typical champions include IT Ops, SRE/DevOps, platform engineering, and NetOps leaders. Economic buyers are often CIOs or senior infrastructure/operations executives. End users include SREs, DevOps, IT Ops, NetOps, and platform teams.

Are we targeting users of existing products? (Instana, Turbo, SevOne, Concert etc.)

As we approach GA (June 15), our primary commercial focus will be on selling the platform to new clients — specifically clients who do not already own existing standalone products such as Turbonomic, Instana, or related offerings.

For existing customers, trade up parts and migration paths are being developed on a post-GA roadmap. We will support customer choice, avoid disruption, and meet clients where they are in their current buying and adoption journey.

We still encourage existing customers to sign up to our public preview to gain access to our interactive demos, to get a feel of the platform capabilities.